

Brand Style Guide Report

A report format for presenting DESIGN.md brand systems. This example turns brand tokens, component rules, and usage constraints into a client-readable style-guide dossier.

Use this when a brand library needs to be reviewed by humans and reused by report agents. The report should be generated from DESIGN . MD plus chapter files, not from memory.

Style-guide manifest

Source library:
. AGENTS/TOOLS/DESIGN/LIBRARY/BRANDS

Purpose: show token coverage, component grammar, constraints, and report usage

Rule: public examples use brand names only; client evidence remains redacted

Example brands: Signal Agency, Apple, IBM, Bento, Times

Export profiles: HTML, A4, US Letter, Slides

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CHAPTER 1

1. How to read this guide

Brand style guides need more than colours and fonts. A report-ready brand package should include visual theme, colour roles, typography, component grammar, layout, elevation, do/don't rules, responsive behaviour, and an agent prompt guide.

§ 01 | Token
inventory |
Colour, type,
spacing, radii

§ 02 |
Component
grammar |
Cards, tables,
badges, source
ledgers, briefs

§ 03 | Brand
examples |
Signal, Apple,
IBM, Bento,
Times

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Reproduction
rules and
validation

2. Token inventory

2.1 Signal Agency — paper and ink

BACKGROUND #ECEEED · warm paper for report pages.

ON-SURFACE #0B0D0A · near-black ink for text, rules, and dossier headers.

Usage: use rule weight and surface changes before adding decoration.

2.2 Signal Agency — terracotta signal

PRIMARY #B93A19 · use for critical decisions, PO emphasis, cover italic, and small glyphs.

Constraint: never flood large areas with the accent; it is a signal, not a background.

2.3 Apple — quiet surfaces

Use restrained neutrals, large whitespace, and product-like hierarchy. Components should feel polished and calm rather than editorial or dossier-like.

2.4 IBM — structured enterprise

Use crisp grids, clear data tables, modular panels, and neutral surfaces. Components should privilege legibility, classification, and enterprise evidence.

2.5 Display type

Large report titles should preserve brand personality. Signal uses condensed Bricolage Grotesque with tight tracking; Times uses newspaper-like editorial serif; IBM uses more systematic enterprise typography.

2.6 Body type

Body copy should stay readable in HTML and PDF. Keep 56-64ch lines, avoid overusing uppercase, and verify print output after font substitution.

2.7 Mono metadata

Use mono labels for source IDs, dates, engine names, priorities, and run IDs. This makes evidence provenance scannable without becoming decorative.

2.8 Code and examples

Code blocks inherit each brand's code surface. Signal stays light; developer-dark styles may invert; all production examples need accessible contrast.

3. Component grammar

3.1 Cover and manifest

The cover sets mood; the manifest proves scope. Include prepared-for, period, source count, version, confidentiality, and next review date.

3.2 KPI cards and stats strips

Use large numerals only for metrics with a period/window and source ID. Avoid unsupported “AI share of voice” claims unless per-engine lines prove them.

3.3 Tables and source ledgers

Tables carry findings; source ledgers carry trust. Use stable columns, evidence badges, confidence labels, and redacted storage notes.

3.4 Priority cards and briefs

Priority cards are executive-readable; implementation briefs are worker-readable. Each needs owner, due date, source IDs, and verification.

4. Brand examples

4.1 Signal Agency

Research-dossier style: warm paper, black rules, terracotta signal, square cards, mono evidence labels, source-led report grammar, and light code blocks. Best for AI-search audit reports, client evidence packs, and editorial strategy documents.

4.2 Apple

Premium product style: reduced chrome, generous spacing, calm hierarchy, elegant typography, and minimal visible borders. Best for executive summaries, product narratives, and polished client-facing recommendations.

4.3 IBM

Enterprise systems style: structured grids, explicit categories, accessible contrast, and utilitarian components. Best for technical audits, governance, architecture, and compliance reports.

4.4 Bento

Modular showcase style: card-based blocks, friendly surface contrast, and concise grouped information. Best for capability overviews and feature-led reports.

4.5 Times

Editorial newspaper style: rule-based hierarchy, serif tone, print-first feel, and restrained emphasis. Best for research digests, competitive narratives, and long-form findings.

5. Agent handoff

- ☒ Start from DESIGN . MD front matter and chapter files.
- ☒ Verify colour, typography, component, layout, elevation, responsive, and prompt-guide coverage.
- ☐ Generate a brand-style-guide report before using a new brand in client reports.
- ☐ Render HTML and print profiles; inspect tables, badges, code blocks, and TOC.
- ☐ Keep public examples free of private client names, URLs, local paths, screenshots, and raw evidence.

Task: Convert a source style guide into a complete DESIGN.md brand library and report preview.

Files: DESIGN.MD, chapter files, report renderer style, brand-style-guide example.

Acceptance: tokens cover colour/type/spacing/radii; components cover cover, cards, tables, badges, ledgers, briefs, checklists; print export has no browser chrome.

Verification: DESIGN.md lint, renderer validate, HTML preview, A4/Letter/slides export, and visual review against source specimen.

